

Ripple Effect

Violence in Punjab as a repercussion of the Vienna killings is the epitome of fanaticism, which is a cause of anguish for those who wish peace ("In the Name of Religion", June 8). It is even more agonising that the politicians unconsciously misinterpret the truth and misguide people for their own clandestine interests. Therefore, it is the responsibility of the heads of the religious sects to preach syncretism to their followers to maintain harmony and brotherhood among humankind.

INDU SHANKAR, Varanasi

Doom and Gloom

With the rout of Ram Vilas Paswan, near-defeat of Lalu Prasad Yadav and downsizing of Mayawati and Mulayam Singh Yadav, there is absolutely nothing surprising about the start of downfall of the by-products of the caste-based reservation policy ("Rout and Retribution", June 8).

All these corrupt casteist leaders are artificial creations of the sensationalism of the media.

A.K.SHARMA,

via www.indiatoday.in

Prudent Practices

Stoppage of cross-border incursions is an essential prerequisite for good relations with Pakistan ("In the Hot Seat", June 8). But our refrain on dis-

mantling the terror infrastructure there as a precondition for talks has begun to sound tedious. India has to demonstrate that pathological hostility is an unaffordable and counter-productive option for Pakistan as well as for its anti-Indian components. Dialogue, as a process rather than bottomline, should proceed and reinforce this signal.

BISHAN SAHAL,

via www.indiatoday.in



“After making a woman the Lok Sabha Speaker, it is hoped that Sonia Gandhi will now get the much-awaited Women's Reservation Bill passed without any dilution.”

SUBHASH CHANDRA AGRAWAL, Delhi

Fading Saffron

The BJP and its prime ministerial candidate L.K. Advani have been drubbed in the general elections and shown the door ("The Comeback Couple", May 25). The debacle of the BJP was mainly because the party supported Varun Gandhi after his hate speech instead of dismissing him.

Also, putting up Narendra Modi as a national figure and future prime minister for the BJP bombed on its face. Not just that, the pre-poll frontal attack on Manmohan Singh on a personal level by Advani misfired badly.

DR. MOTUPALLI S. PRASAD,
Chennai

Missing Links

It is surprising that the most challenging crises of food, water and environ-

ment did not find place in the agenda for the future government ("What India Needs", May 11). With multiplying population, ever-increasing poverty and disturbing climate change, it is imperative that the Government should address these issues on top priority.

DR V. RAJAGOPAL,

via www.indiatoday.in

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

AUGUST 1-15, 1979

Marxist Disharmony

Throughout July, the Left Front Government of West Bengal—which never tires of portraying itself as a "picture of cohesion"—was an opera playing out of tune. Chief Minister Jyoti Basu was holidaying in Europe for three weeks from July 1, while his colleagues, who should have been getting along wonderfully together, boycotted each other, swapped innuendos, and, on occasions, even fought like alley-cats. Basu, under great strain due to the continuing power crisis and relentless attacks from opposition parties, had been advised to go on tour by his doctors. There was a pending invitation from the UK, extended during the earlier Labour government. Margaret Thatcher's Conservative government renewed it, reflecting the British politicians' concern for investment worth Rs 650 crore in India. A large chunk of this is in West Bengal. Keeping to accepted international Marxist protocol, Basu tied up his visit to a bourgeois country with trips to socialist Yugoslavia and Poland.

Sumit Mitra



JYOTI
BASU

Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquiries before sending money, incurring expenses or entering into commitments in relation to any advertisement appearing in this publication. The India Today Group does not vouch for any claims made by the advertisers of products and services. The printer, publisher, editor-in-chief and the editor of the India Today Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences in the event of such claims not being honoured by the advertisers.

E-MAIL YOUR LETTERS TO: letters.editor@intoday.com

FAX THEM TO: 011-23316180

OR LOG ON TO: www.indiatoday.in